Looking for limitations and pitfalls of AWS Lambda? Stay tuned: you will find a discussion of Lambda's limitations at the end of the chapter.

That's all you need to know about AWS Lambda to be able to go through the first real-world example. Are you ready?

6.2 Building a website health check with AWS Lambda

Are you responsible for the uptime of a website or application? We do our best to make sure our blog https://cloudonaut.io is accessible 24/7. An external health check acts as a safety net, making sure we, and not our readers, are the first to know when our blog goes down. AWS Lambda is the perfect choice for building a website health check, because you do not need computing resources constantly but only every few minutes for a few milliseconds. This section guides you through setting up a health check for your website based on AWS Lambda.

In addition to AWS Lambda, we are using the Amazon CloudWatch service for this example. Lambda functions publish metrics to CloudWatch by default. Typically, you inspect metrics using charts and create alarms by defining thresholds. For example, a metric could count failures during the function's execution. On top of that, EventBridge provides events that can be used to trigger Lambda functions as well. Here we are using a rule to publish an event every five minutes.

As shown in figure 6.2, your website health check will consist of the following three parts: